

CUNY AI LAB

Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01

CUNY Graduate Center

Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

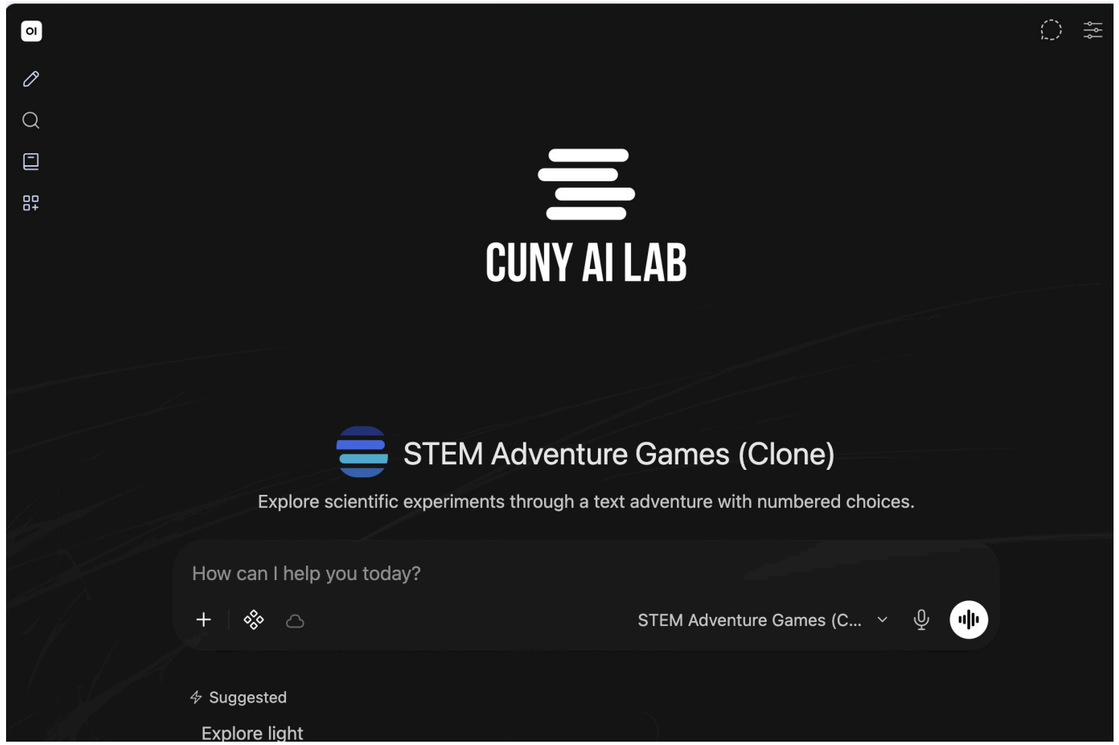
https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

Choose Your Own Adventure

Continue your saved model, or clone **STEM Adventure Games**

Read its system prompt for setting, goals, and rules

Clone instructions · Adventure example



What Is a Skill?

Skills contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

Trigger	Request or condition that starts a procedure
Procedure	Steps, checks, and points that require a question
Output	Required response content and form

Skill Examples

Workspace → Skills · 1 of 3

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

History Of Ideas Abstract Critique /history-of-ideas-abstract-critique 3 days ago

Guide revision of relationships among ideas and their implications.

Historical Context Abstract Critique /historical-context-abstract-critique 3 days ago

Guide revision of historical conditions as drivers of intellectual change.

Extend STEM Adventures /extend-stem-adventures a month ago

Add a source-based experimental procedure to STEM Adventure, or examine a submitted play record.

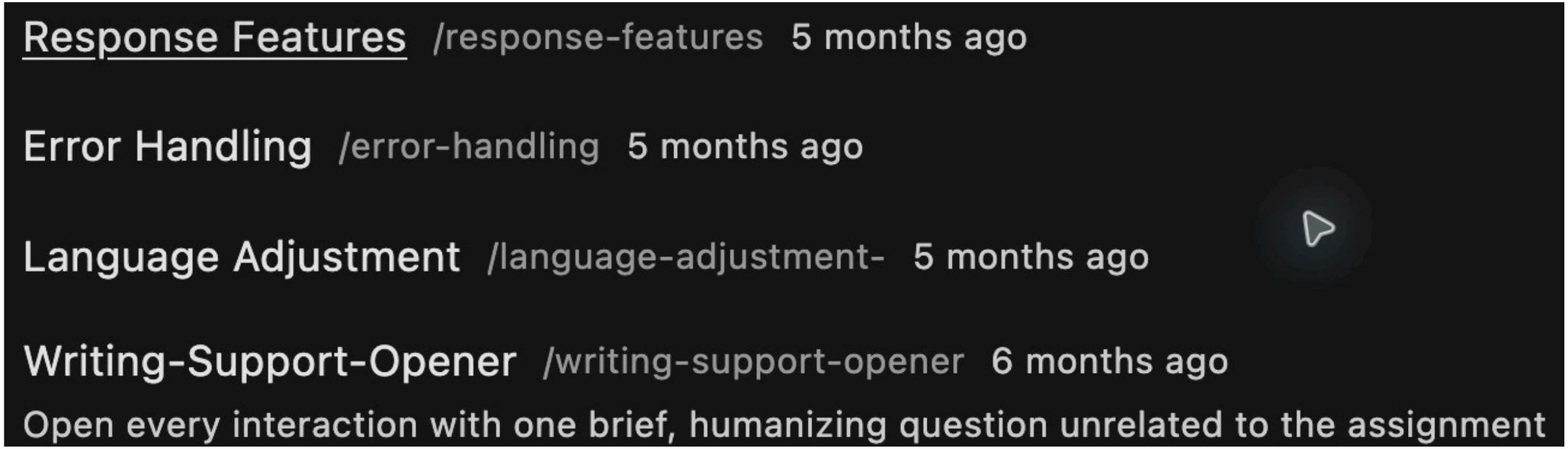
ChartJS Visualization /chartjs-visualization 2 months ago

Use whenever a request would benefit from plotting quantitative data or mathematical relationships, even when the user ...

Skill Examples

Workspace → Skills · 2 of 3

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access



Skill Examples

Workspace → Skills · 3 of 3

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Conversational Etiquette /conversational-etiquette 6 months ago

Supports short, turn-taking dialogue as a prose-first, anti-slop corrective

Native Orthography /preserve-native-orthography 6 months ago

Preserves correct native spelling, scripts, diacritics, and punctuation across languages.

One-Step Dialogue /adaptive_conversational_scaffolding_v1 6 months ago

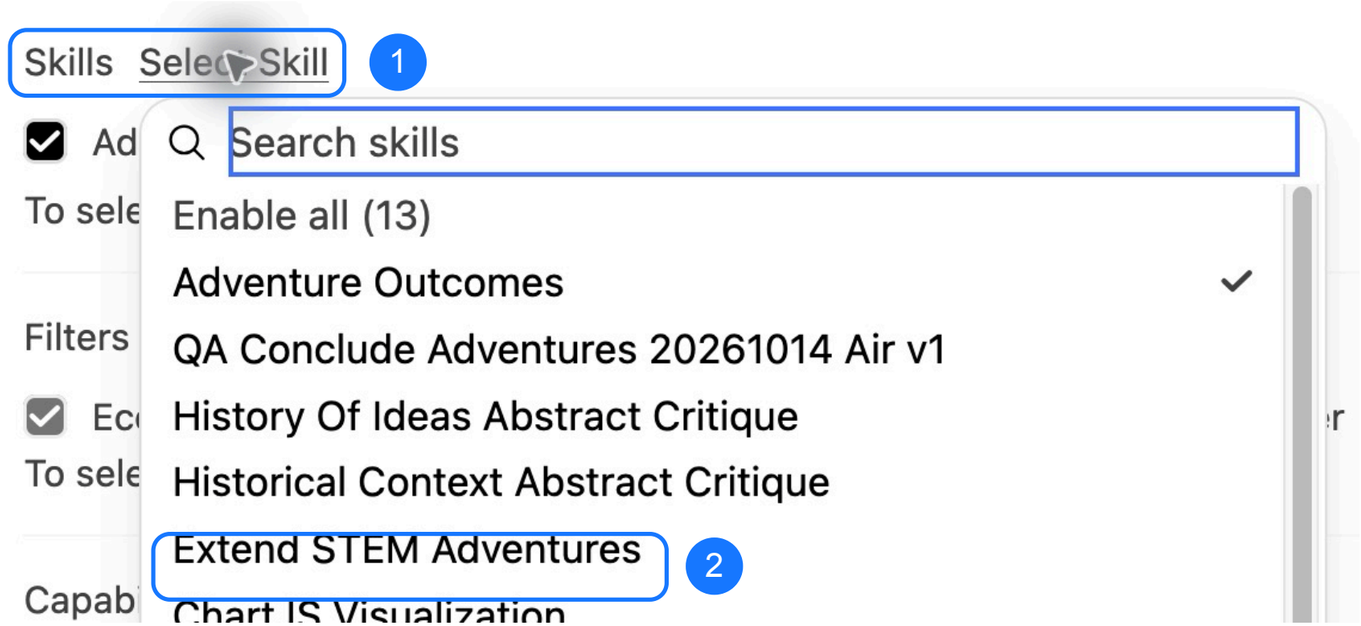
Pedagogical scaffolding for inquisitive dialogue following a one-step extension + question per turn

Add Your Skill

Open **Workspace → Models**, then choose **Edit** from your model card's menu

① Under **Skills**, click **Select Skill** · ② Choose **Extend STEM Adventures** if available

Click **Save & Update** to save your model



Add Skill Instructions

Add this short clause to your model's system prompt · Copy clause

When I ask to extend our adventure or review a Play record, check the attached Extend STEM Adventures skill. Follow the setting and rules in this system prompt.

Save your model, then check that the saved skill loads and follows its instructions

Test Your Skill

Ask your model to use the selected skill for its stated task

Use an actual record of choices and results
Leave out required information and check for a question
Ask to stop before the goal is met

Which task in your teaching or research needs a repeatable procedure?

What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, Sandbox executes a function and returns its result

Tool calling, otherwise known as **function calling**, sends a function name and arguments for execution

Input	Arguments supplied to a function
Execution	Code that applies specified rules
Result	Returned output for a model to inspect

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 1 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Adventure Kit v2.0.0 8 hours ago

Create participant-defined choice adventures with configurable state, rules and endings. No built-in scenario.

Chat Export v0.3.1 21 hours ago

Saves chat content (headings, text, lists and tables) as a downloadable Word (.docx) or PDF file, plus Markdow…

Instructor Rubric v0.4.0 21 hours ago

Checks student lab work without revealing answers. Verifies ONE calculation per lab part, flags data that break…

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 2 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

OCR reader v0.2.0 2 days ago

reads scanned or image-only PDFs (and images) that come up blank. Runs OCR on pages with no text layer and...

Instructional Toolset v0.6.0 3 days ago

Deterministically lists and loads curriculum units for instructional AI models.

Pronunciation and Translation Tool ✨ v5.1.1 3 days ago

https://openwebui.com/posts/pronunciation_and_translation_tool_d8a83bca

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 3 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Graphing v0.1.0 a month ago

Graphing tool

PhysicsPY v0.4.0 2 months ago

Source-grounded physics laboratory analysis with static SVG charts.

ChartJS v2.0.0 2 months ago

Charts is a tool for the Sandbox that renders chart elements in-chat using an HTML5 canvas via Chart.js cdn

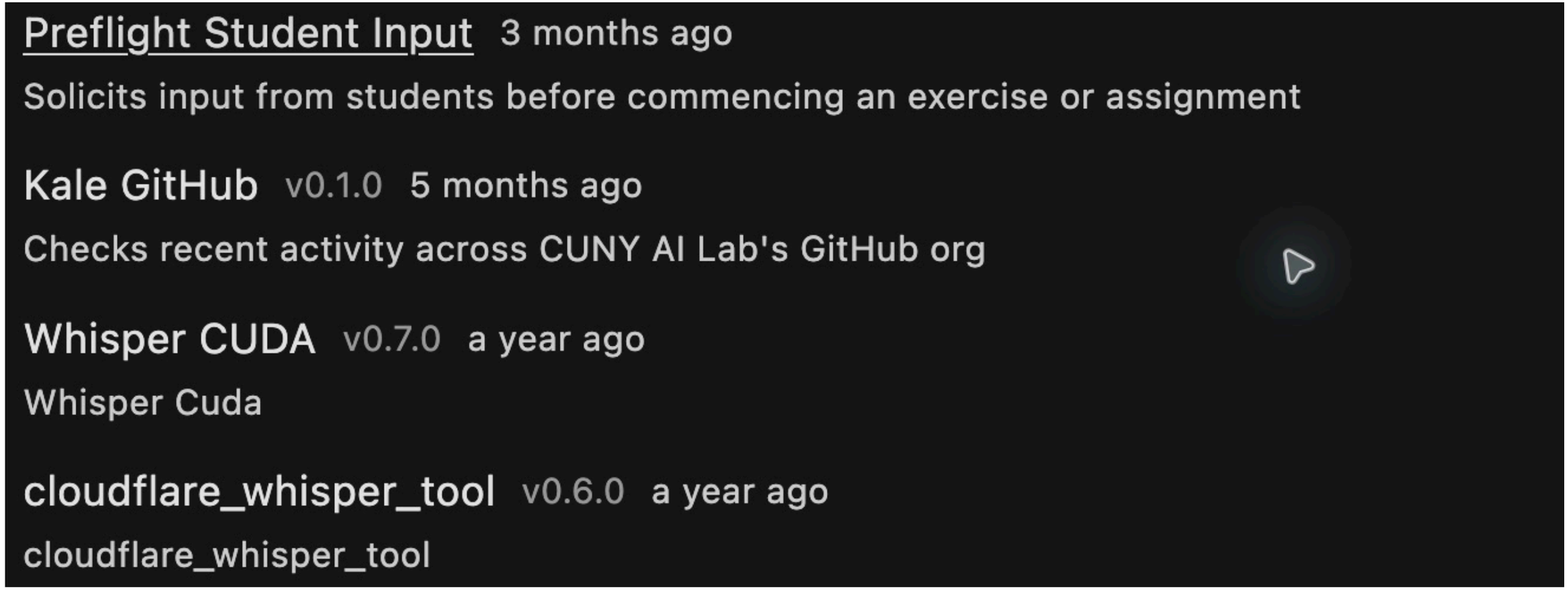
Charts (v1) v1.3.0 2 months ago

Charts is a tool for OpenWebUI that allows you to create charts using the Chart.js cdn

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 4 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access



Check Tool Binding

Model Bound Tool Enabler is a filter that restores model-attached tools when a chat request omits them

If an attached tool is missing from call details, use this existing filter on your private model and repeat your test

It restores availability; execution still requires a valid tool call

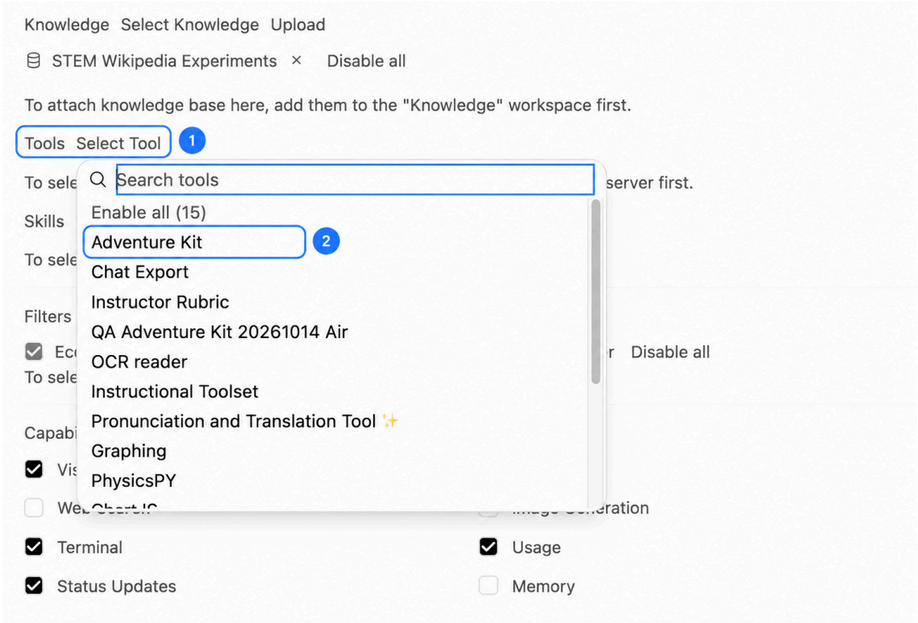
Configuration checks and evidence record

Add the ‘Adventure Kit’ tool

Open **Workspace → Models**, then choose **Edit** from your model card’s menu

① Under **Tools**, click **Select Tool** · ② Choose **Adventure Kit**

Click **Save & Update** to save your model



Prepare Your Adventure

Design your adventure from your system prompt

Instruct your model to map its setting, goals, and rules into scenes, choices, and end conditions

Resolve missing or contradictory instructions
Review proposed input for **Adventure Kit**

Copy preparation and run requests

Add Tool Instructions

Add this clause to your model's system prompt · Copy clause

When I approve an adventure, call the attached Adventure Kit tool to run it. Use the setting, goals, and rules in this system prompt.

Save your model, then verify tool attachment, provider support, and the actual result

Test Your Tool

Run your reviewed adventure, then compare its scene and choices with your prompt

Try a choice before and after its prerequisite
Inspect Undo and Stop
Copy actual play record into chat

Which step in your teaching or research needs an executable operation?

Choose Your Task

Revise One Item

Copy complete tool code or skill instructions

Describe an observed problem and one change

Copy tool code · Skill instructions

Create Your Own

Choose your own tool or skill

Specify purpose, required input, and expected result

Work With Support

Open **CAIL Workspace Support**

Paste original content or your new task, system prompt, and required sources

Request complete content, an explanation, and one test · Copy request



Situate Your Adventure

At **CAIL Workspace Support**, design a skill for the adventure you just played

Trigger	Adapt this adventure to one lesson outcome
Inputs	Model prompt, lesson plan, weekly concept, current scene, and a dated news example or statistic
Output	Revised choices that ask students to apply theory and question the evidence

Preserve game rules and Stop · Copy the Support request

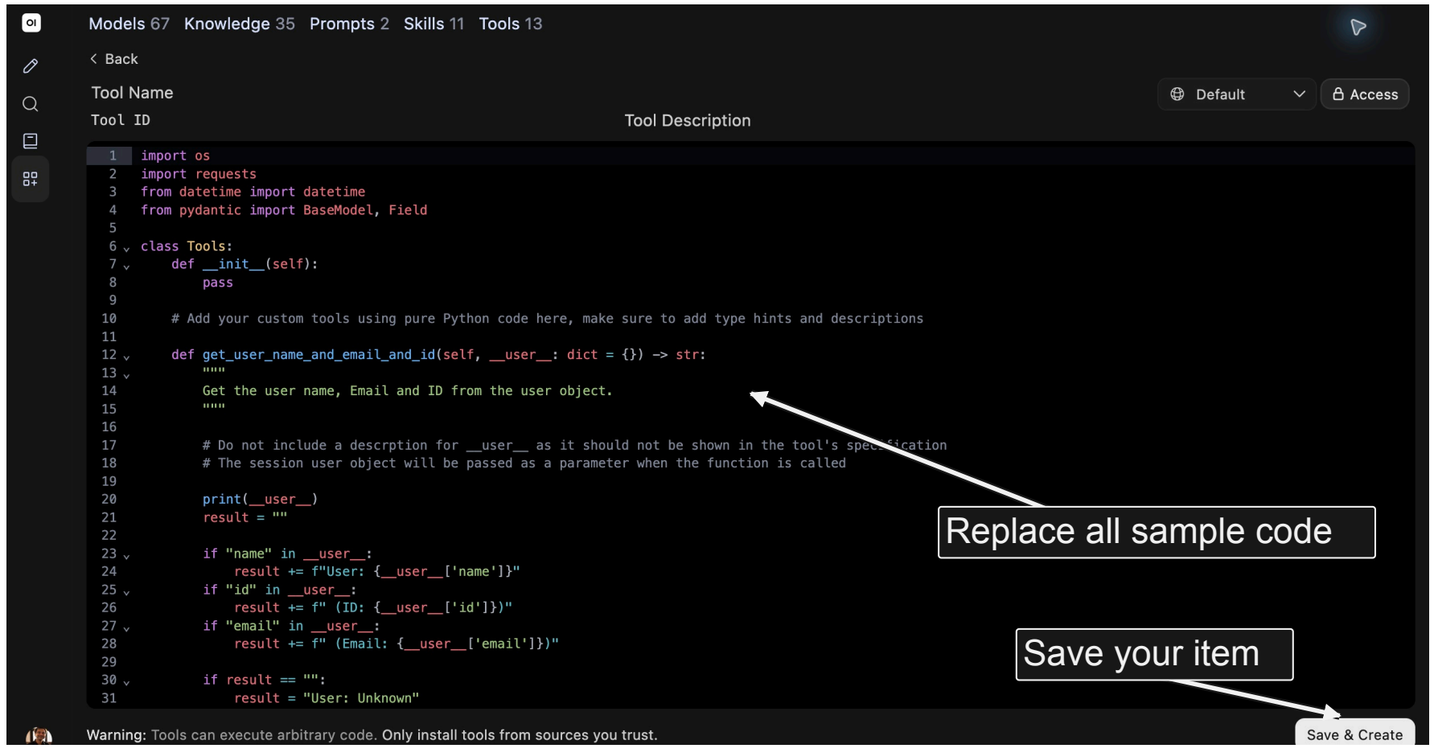
Add Tools or Skills

Create a new **tool** or **skill**, or save a revised copy

Use **Workspace → Tools → Create** or **Skills → Create**

Enter new Name and ID; paste complete reviewed content

Review **Access**, then **Save & Create** · Select and test your item



Series Reflections

What task in your teaching or research could benefit from a skill or tool?

Would you be interested in joining our coworking session on October 29, 2–4pm, to build your adventure into a collection so that we can showcase our work over the course of the series?

What would you develop next with the prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools you have explored?